

AI Risk Register Template

Company: [COMPANY NAME]

Register owner: [AI GOVERNANCE LEAD]

Review cadence: [MONTHLY / QUARTERLY / ANNUALLY]

Date started:

How to use. Use this register as the living list of AI risks your organization has identified. The inventory tells you what tools and workflows exist. The intake/impact assessment documents a specific use. The risk register lets you track cross-cutting risks, owners, mitigations, status, and review dates.

1. Field schema

Use these fields in a spreadsheet, GRC tool, Notion table, Airtable base, or document table.

Field	Description
Risk ID	Unique identifier, for example RISK-AI-001
Title	Short plain-English risk name
Description	What could happen and why it matters
Category	Accuracy, bias, privacy, security, legal/regulatory, operational, financial, reputation, safety, vendor, governance
Source	Intake form, impact assessment, incident, complaint, audit, vendor review, staff report, regulatory update
AI tool / workflow	Related inventory entry or system name
Population affected	Customers, employees, students, patients, applicants, public, internal users, other
Jurisdictions	Relevant locations, if known
Inherent likelihood	1-5 before controls
Inherent impact	1-5 before controls
Existing controls	Current mitigations
Residual likelihood	1-5 after controls
Residual impact	1-5 after controls
Residual score	Residual likelihood x residual impact
Treatment decision	Accept, reduce, transfer, avoid, monitor
Owner	Named person accountable for the risk
Next action	Specific action, not a vague intention
Due date	Date for next action
Status	Open, monitoring, treatment in progress, mitigated, closed

Next review date	Date the risk should be revisited
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2. Starter register

Delete the example rows and replace them with real risks.

Risk ID	Title	Category	AI tool / workflow	Residual score	Owner	Status	Next action	Due date
RISK-AI-001	Sensitive data entered into unapproved AI tools	Privacy / governance	Cross-team AI use	12		Open	Confirm approved tools and send rules	
RISK-AI-002	AI output used externally without human review	Accuracy / reputation	Marketing and support drafts	9		Monitoring	Add review rule to policy and rollout message	
RISK-AI-003	Vendor trains on company inputs by default	Vendor / privacy	[TOOL NAME]	10		Treatment in progress	Confirm opt-out or restrict data	
RISK-AI-004	AI used in employment or candidate decisions without review	Bias / legal	Hiring workflow	15		Open	Pause use and complete full impact assessment	
RISK-AI-005	AI tool gains new feature or model without policy update	Operational	Approved AI tools	8		Monitoring	Add vendor notices to update tracker	

3. Scoring rubric

Likelihood

Score	Meaning	Prompt
1	Rare	Would be surprising
2	Unlikely	Plausible but not expected
3	Possible	Could happen during normal operations
4	Likely	Expected within the year
5	Almost certain	Expected soon or already happening

Impact

Score	Meaning	Prompt
1	Negligible	Minor inconvenience or rework
2	Minor	Limited operational issue
3	Moderate	Material business, customer, privacy, or quality concern
4	Major	Serious customer harm, contract issue, regulatory issue, or public incident
5	Severe	Rights, safety, systemic harm, major regulatory exposure, or existential business risk

Residual score guide

Residual score	Suggested handling
1-3	Monitor during normal review
4-7	Assign owner and review at least annually
8-11	Treatment plan and quarterly review
12-14	Leadership visibility and monthly/quarterly review
15-25	Escalate before launch or expansion

4. Risk treatment worksheet

Use this section for any risk with a residual score of 8 or higher, or any risk that leadership wants tracked closely.

Risk ID:

Risk title:

Owner:

Current residual score:

Target residual score:

Treatment option	Selected?	Notes
Accept		Why is the residual risk acceptable?
Reduce		What control will lower likelihood or impact?
Transfer		Insurance, contract, vendor obligation, or other transfer path
Avoid		Stop, redesign, remove data, or do not launch

Monitor		What evidence will be watched and how often?
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Treatment plan:

Evidence that the treatment is working:

Next review date:

5. Closure checklist

Close a risk only when the closure rationale is written down.

- ☐ Owner agrees the risk can be closed
- ☐ Treatment actions are complete or no longer needed
- ☐ Evidence is linked or attached
- ☐ Residual risk is within appetite
- ☐ Closure rationale is recorded
- ☐ Closed risk remains available for future review

Disclaimer

This document is a template for educational and informational purposes only. It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship. Consult qualified counsel before relying on this register for compliance decisions.